

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

A beautiful dance tradition.



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- What kinds of traditional dance are you familiar with?
- What are some purposes for dancing other than just entertainment?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about myths and legends, culture and traditions.
- I can report facts about events and actions.
- I can understand and explain the sequence of events or give the reason for something in the past.





Let's Explore!

Is dance **entertainment***, worship, meditation or exercise?

* "Entertainment" is something that keeps people interested or enjoying themselves.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

One of the art forms that has held special importance over the centuries in Indian culture has been dance. Styles of dance being performed now are centuries old. Originally, dancers had performed in temples as a form of worship. Musicians and dancers had been considered servants of god and were respected and encouraged in their art.

One of the most famous classical temple dances is called Odissi, which originated in eastern India. Sculptures being found in the temples of Orissa proved that the Odissi dance is hundreds of years old. These sculptures show just how significant Odissi had been at that time. At first, only the Maharis, or temple dancers had trained to dance the Odissi. The Maharis had chosen to dedicate their lives to the temple so they devoted themselves to perfecting their dance. They did not marry because it was thought that they were married to the god of the temple.

They would perform the dance inside the temple for the god without being watched by anyone else. In fact, all classical temple dance was created as a form of meditation, worship, and devotion rather than as a performing art. After the Mahari tradition had eventually faded, a new group of dancers took over the Odissi tradition. The dancers being chosen were young boys called Gotipuas. The Gotipuas were the first to bring Odissi outside of the temple. Before the Gotipuas started dancing, it had never been seen by other people. The exquisite ancient dance being enjoyed today is just one of the examples of the rich beauty of ancient Indian culture.





Let's Practice!

Lucy is trying to remember some key words!

Instructions: Find the words in the word search. Model a conversation using the words. Switch roles.

Words

1. Centuries
2. Sculptures
3. Ancient
4. Exquisite
5. Worship
6. Classical



Let's Practice!

Lucy is reviewing her notes about dancing!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the correct option to complete the sentence correctly. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Originally, dancers **perform / are performing / had performed** in temples as a form of worship.
2. These sculptures show just how significant Odissi **have been/ is / had been** at that time.
3. At first, only the Maharis, or temple dancers **training / had trained / train** to dance the Odissi.
4. After the Mahari tradition **will fade / had eventually faded / have eventually faded**, a new group of dancers took over the Odissi tradition.
5. Before the Gotipuas started dancing the Orissa, it **have never been seeing / had never been seen / was never saw** by other people.





Extension Activity

Watch TED Talk: Significance of Traditional Indian Dance. (Rukmini Vijayakumar)

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch the TED Talk Significance of Traditional Indian Dance online.
- Take notes as you watch. Watch as many times as you need.
- Look up any new words that you hear.
- Write 1-2 paragraphs to summarize the information you heard in the video.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I watch a TED Talk video.

☐ ☐

I take notes while I watch a video.

☐ ☐

I look up new vocabulary.

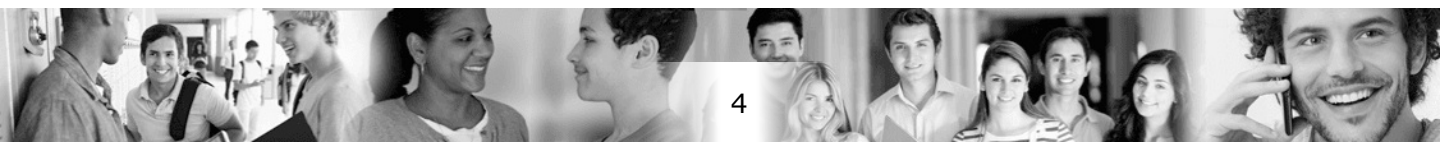
☐ ☐

I write a summary of the video.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **century** (noun): one hundred years
e.g. One of the art forms that has held special importance over the centuries in Indian culture has been dance.
- **classical** (adjective): traditional in style or form, or based on methods developed over a long period of time
e.g. One of the most famous classical temple dances is called Odissi.
- **sculpture** (noun): a solid object that represents a thing, person, idea, etc. made out of a material such as wood, clay or metal
e.g. These sculptures show just how significant Odissi had been at that time.
- **to dedicate** (verb): to give all of your energy, time, etc.
e.g. The Maharis had chosen to dedicate their lives to the temple.
- **worship** (noun): a strong feeling of respect and admiration for a god
e.g. All classical temple dance was created as a form of meditation, worship, and devotion rather than as a performing art.
- **to fade** (verb): to lose strength or importance gradually
e.g. After the Mahari tradition had eventually faded, a new group of dancers took over the Odissi tradition.
- **exquisite** (adjective): very beautiful
e.g. The exquisite ancient dance being enjoyed today is just one of the examples of the rich beauty of ancient Indian culture.
- **ancient** (adjective): very old
e.g. There are many ancient traditions that continue to be followed today.





Learning Points

The Participle Clause: Present and Past Participle

Participle clauses can be placed after a noun just like relative clauses. They provide more information about the noun.

You can use *being* + *past participle* as you would use a continuous passive relative clause:

*The speech **being delivered** by the politician was written by his assistant.*
(= The speech that is being delivered by the politician was written by his assistant).

*The ice cream sundae **being prepared** will have chocolate, strawberry and vanilla ice cream.*
(= The sundae that is being prepared will have chocolate, strawberry and vanilla ice cream).

Examples:

- *Styles of dance being performed now are centuries old.*
- *Sculptures being found in the temples of Orissa prove that the Odissi dance is hundreds of years old.*
- *They would perform the dance inside the temple for the god without being watched by anyone else.*
- *The dancers being chosen were young boys called Gotipuas.*
- *The exquisite ancient dance being enjoyed today is just one of the examples of the rich beauty of ancient Indian culture.*





Learning Points

Uses of the Past Perfect Tense

The Past Perfect is a very useful tense in narratives. It can be used in a variety of ways.

Look at the chart for the different uses of the Past Perfect tense and examples:

Use	Example
A completed action before something else in the past.	<i>When we arrived, the movie had started.</i> (= first the movie started, and then we arrived)
To give a reason for something that happened the past.	<i>It had rained during the week, so the road was in bad shape.</i> (= first it rained during the week, then the road became in bad shape)
Stative verbs only: something that started in the past and continued up to another action in the past.	<i>By the time he had graduated, he had been studying in Toronto for over five years.</i> (= he started studying in Toronto five years before he graduated)

Examples:

- *Originally, dancers had performed in temples as a form of worship.*
- *These sculptures show just how significant Odissi had been at that time.*
- *At first, only the Maharis, or temple dancers had trained to dance the Odissi.*
- *The Maharis had chosen to dedicate their lives to the temple so they devoted themselves to perfecting their dance.*
- *After the Mahari tradition had eventually faded, a new group of dancers took over the Odissi tradition.*
- *Before the Gotipuas started dancing the Orissa, it had never been seen by other people.*

